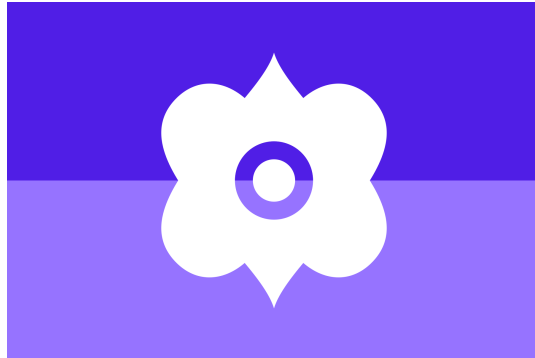


DAGAPYA



Dagapya is a minimalistic constructed language created by Vecderg in 2024. Initially created as an [international auxiliary language](#), it maintains suitability for that role while also having elements of [artlangs](#) and [philosophical languages](#).

Dagapya has an [oligosynthetic](#) vocabulary of about 800 root words which were formed by sound symbolism, but is still considered [a priori](#) since every word must be learned from scratch.

Its sentences are as simple or complicated as the user wants them to be, and words can be compounded with essentially full freedom.

Every root word is two syllables or less. There are no homophones, even within compounds.

(Turn on Outline to jump to sections more easily!)

Official website: <https://www.dagapya.com/>

1.0 - OVERVIEW

Dagapya uses 5 vowels and 13 consonants, which all correspond to their [IPA equivalent](#), except for Y, which is [j] like in English.

A E I O U

B D G H K L M N P S T W Y

- Every root word is 2 syllables or less

- Roots never change
- Capitalization not required
- No articles like “an” or “the” (can use “min” or “pin” or “san” as substitutes)
- Any word can be omitted if understandable from context
- Compound words freely formed by having the main word at the end and describing words in front
- Subject-Verb-Object order by default, marked by preceding them with the particles a / i / e respectively
 - Order can be modified as long as they’re marked with the particles
 - “a” can be dropped if it would begin a sentence
- Adjectives come before nouns, adverbs before verbs/adjectives
- Words can be used as any part of speech based on context
- Questions do not affect word order, and use the question marker “kay” at the beginning of the sentence
- Nouns can be singular or plural, but can be specified with “min” or “moy”
- Past tense: precede verb with “mye”
- Future tense: precede verb with “dyu”
- Conditional mood: precede verb with “myu”
- In cases of ambiguity, can add word at the end for type
 - goy - thing / object noun suffix
 - mun - abstract noun suffix (like -ness)
 - sin - to do / verb suffix
 - ben - related / -ly / adjective suffix

2.0 - VOCABULARY

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1hJNNrFScHDIVDssH3je-ShFpglvbh6yoNgL93WJ_xKo/

Note that most “official” compound words in Dagapya are descriptive, not prescriptive. Any concept can be referred to by any compound word as long as it’s logical and can be understood.

2.1 - EXAMPLE SENTENCES

bamu! = Hello!

gwi masu! = Good morning!

pan i dani e sapa. = I like fish.

kay a kyu legi e kya? = What’s your job?

seyhan a pan i sin e pin. = I’ll do this tomorrow.

3.0 - ABOUT

Dagapya was initially created for one reason: to create my ideal auxlang. At the time of writing, there is still no oligosynthetic auxlang that can be considered notably popular, even by the standards of constructed languages. Dagapya (initially called Taynmoga, then Dasopya) was designed to address the issues that I felt they had.

While I would still consider Dagapya to be my most ideal auxlang, it no longer feels correct to refer to it solely as an auxlang. It has the elements of an artlang, a philosophical language, and even a personal language.

There is no practical reason for an auxlang to have a root word meaning “rawr,” or make compound words unambiguous with no homophones, or to make a single word a posteriori because it’s a reference to one of my favorite video games, but these are things that, I decided, mattered to me. It’s why **there is no description more correct than to say that this language came from the heart**. If I had to put it into a box though, I would say that Dagapya is an artlang meant for anyone and everyone to speak.

Dagapya weighs on the research and existence of other languages that have had more testing and scrutiny, so it’s fair to say that it could not exist without them – mainly toki pona, Mini-Linga, and Globasa. Other languages that have had varying degrees of influence are English, Japanese, Esperanto, and Kah. I also used [sound symbolism](#) by both studying previous research and extracting phonemes common between multiple languages – outside the previously mentioned ones, this includes Arabic, Hindi, Mandarin Chinese, and Spanish.

As a note, Dagapya was NOT created to compete with any other language, constructed or natural, but is instead designed to be simple enough to coexist with the knowledge of other languages. I encourage others to explore uses for this language.

Special thanks: SandwichDeer, ChristianSi, seweli, Aronora, hexedbug, Gojiberry, and holycannoli!

- Vecderg

4.0 - ALPHABET

4.1 - Orthography

Dagapya is written using the Latin alphabet, with no accent marks. Capitalization is fully optional, but these are the preferred rules:

- All letters are lowercase by default
- The first letter after the loanward prefix o- should be capitalized, along with any following part of the loanword separated by a hyphen.
- The first letter of any proper noun that isn't a loanword should be capitalized (e.g. a fox named Fox would be translated as "Duba")

Dagapya will be capitalized in this document only because it would be considered a proper noun in English.

4.2 - Phonology

4.2.1 - Alphabet

Every letter abides by the one-letter-one-sound principle, so there are no letters that change sound depending on placement (e.g. when paired with another letter). The only exceptions to this are optional, and will be covered in detail.

Due to most sounds being generally distinct, there is some wiggle room allowed in how every letter is pronounced. As long as each letter is distinct and understandable, it is OK to use. Here is every letter with sample preferred pronunciations in order from most to least preferred:

(much of this chart was taken from [Globasa](#))

letter	IPA	pronunciation	letter name
a	[a]	as in <i>hat</i>	An
b	[b] or [v]	as in <i>boy</i>	oBa
d	[d] or [ð]	as in <i>dip</i>	oDa
e	[e]	as in <i>let</i>	En
g	[g]	as in <i>good</i>	oGa

h	[h] [x] [ɣ] or [f]	as <i>h</i> in <i>hole</i>	oHa
i	[i]	as in <i>ski</i>	In
k	[kʰ] or [k]	as in <i>kite</i>	oKe
l	[l] or [r]	as in <i>log</i>	oLe
m	[m]	as in <i>map</i>	oMa
n	[n]	as in <i>nine</i>	oNe
o	[o]	as in <i>more</i>	On
p	[pʰ] [p] or [f]	as in <i>peace</i>	oPe
s	[s] [θ] [ʃ] or [z]	as in <i>sit</i>	oSs
t	[tʰ] or [t]	as in <i>time</i>	oTe
u	[u]	as in <i>flu</i>	Un
w	[w] or [u] or [v] or [o]	as in <i>win</i>	oWa
y	[j] or [i]	as in <i>yes</i>	oYa

While there are many alternatives given to account for what speakers might prefer, try not to use the same alternative that would confuse 2 letters (e.g. [v] for both B and W).

The exceptions to this are pronouncing Y and W as vowels, which can be pronounced as [i] and [u] respectively, since their letter placement will never create ambiguity with the respective vowels (e.g. “kwa” can be pronounced like [kua] or [kuwa], but [kwa] is still preferable). As a note, W can also be pronounced as [o] (e.g. “daw” can be [dao]) EXCEPT when followed by the letter l, since that would lead to ambiguity (e.g. “gwi” as [goi] would sound the same as “goy” [goj]).

Ideally, roots with 1 vowel should be pronounced as 1 syllable, and roots with 2 vowels should be pronounced as 2 syllables. They’ll generally be referred to as 1-syllable roots and 2-syllable roots in this document.

4.2.2 - The letter N

Since words can end in -N, this can cause some unnatural clusters. These are all permitted alternatives when N is at the end of a syllable:

- Lengthening the time N is pronounced to make it more audible

- Changing the sound to [ŋ] before a K or G, like the two N's in the English word "thinking"
- Changing the sound to [m], especially before a B or P
 - Make sure to NOT do this before a starting M, since it can make things sound more ambiguous (e.g. pimo- VS pinmo-)

4.2.3 - Tonic Stress

Tonic stress (spoken emphasis) should be put on the last syllable of every word – compound or not – and is never applied on the single-letter vowel particles. This allows words to be differentiated more easily, and contributes to how the language sounds.

swe i lase mabo e lakekupa (they quickly eat red fruit)
 = SWE i laSE maBO e lakekuPA = ['swe i la'se ma'bo e lakeku'pa]

For compound words with 3 syllables or more (where single vowel particles are still ignored), the speaker can optionally put secondary stress on the first syllable of the word, but primary stress still must be on the last syllable.

lakekupa = LAkeku**PA** = [ˌlakeku'pa]

If the speaker prefers pronouncing diphthongs as 2 separate syllables, the stress should never be placed on the semivowel (i.e. W and Y) to maintain clarity. For example:

kwe = KWE = ['kwe]
or kuE = [ku'e]
not KUe = ['kue]

daw = DAW = ['daw]
or DAu = ['dau]
not daU = [da'u]

For these examples, [ku'we] and ['dawu] are also accepted pronunciations.

If the speaker is more comfortable with tones, this stress can be simulated with a high tone. For example, "gadu" can be pronounced "gadù" where all other syllables are a low or mid tone.

5.0 - GRAMMAR

5.1 - Vocabulary

All 2-syllable roots are sorted roughly by theme based on their second vowel. A is related to life and the body, E is related to adjectives, I is related to actions, O is related to physical objects/places, and U is related to concepts.

This sorting is solely for memorization purposes and should not be seen as any restriction as to how they can be used. For example, “duso” is an object and means “soap,” but can also be used to mean “soapy,” which is an adjective and not an object.

5.2 - Phonotactics

****This information is not important for learning the language, but is here in case new words may be added.**

The phonotactics for any syllable is: (C)(G)V(G)(N)

Where C = consonant, V = vowel, N is the letter N, and G is a glide (W or Y both valid).

In Dagapya, the first syllable of 2-syllable root words MUST be only CV, while 1-syllable root words can be anything as long as it isn't just CV. This allows them to be differentiated in compound words.

Examples of valid 2-syllable root words:

tuka, bogu, hadin, papey, gepyo, dugwa, kegaw, mesayn

Examples of valid 1-syllable root words:

hoy, dya, twa, baw, mon, dyey, gwaw, tyon, pyawn

(Vowel-only words are reserved for particles that are not considered root words)

My research has given me the impression that this should be sufficiently possible for most speakers, and more difficult combinations have been removed. For example, “puw” would sound too similar to “pu”, and “nni” would be impossible to distinguish from “ni” without adding uncommon pronunciation rules. So, root words cannot start with an N since it would be indistinguishable from words ending with an N. Similarly, root words can't start with a W or Y.

There are also combinations that are technically OK, but seemed awkward to pronounce either as one syllable or in general depending on the speaker. See words like “pewn,” “bway,” and “tuyn.”

List of combinations that are not allowed:

- Any double letters (WW / YY / NN / etc.)
- IY / YI
- WO / UW / WU
- HY / HW
- MW / BW / PW / NW
- UY / IW / EW / OW in the same syllable (e.g. kiwe OK root, kiw NOT OK root)
- Beginning root with N (beginning of second syllable in 2-syllable root OK)
- Beginning root with W (beginning of second syllable in 2-syllable root OK)
- Beginning root with Y (beginning of second syllable in 2-syllable root OK)

5.3 - Parts of Speech

All root words can be used as any part of speech depending on placement and use of particles.

5.3.1 - Nouns

By default, nouns can be plural or singular, definite or indefinite, since Dagapya does not have articles or a plural suffix. For example:

koko = (the) rock(s), a rock, some rocks

gaw = (the) animal(s), an animal, some animals

To specify this, you can use “min,” “pin,” and/or “san.”

min koko = a rock

san gaw = that animal

You can also specify plurality with “moy.”

moy koko = multiple rocks

moy san gaw = those animals

“goy” and “mun” can convert words to nouns. Other words can do this too, but these help provide the most disambiguation.

tamyegoy = fun-thing = toy
gosyemun = sticky-concept = stickiness

5.3.2 - Descriptors

Adjectives and adverbs have no distinction in Dagapya, and are instead considered “descriptors.”

Descriptors come before what they describe, whether it is a noun, verb, or adjective. Even if a root word is normally e.g. a noun, using it before another root word makes it interpreted as a descriptor.

lase luso = fast car
lase pyu = fast go = quickly go
bopo tako = sphere container = spherical container

Similarly, if a word is used in a compound word and it isn't the base word, it's also considered a descriptor.

kamidaw = buy-person = buyer
laseluso = speed-car = racecar

To make this less ambiguous in speech, you can use “ben”/“sun” as a suffix to turn something into an adjective.

laseben luso = speed-y car
kudoysun tuli = pillow-like touch

5.3.3 - Verbs

In sentences, verbs can be easily identified with the verb “i” particle, but you can also use “sin” when necessary in other situations.

pan i kiso = I chair = I sit
kisosin = chair-do = to sit

By default, verbs can be any tense or mood based on context, but are normally interpreted as being the simple present, infinitive, and present progressive tense.

i deki = leave, to leave, to be leaving, etc.
seyhan a pan i deki = Tomorrow, I (will) leave

5.3.4 - Pronouns

Pronouns can be adapted by using the base pronouns (pan/swe/kyu) and compounding it with other words.

pan = me / I

panhey = me-self = myself

moypan = multiple-me = we/us

swe = they/them

moyswe = them (plural)

byaswe / mawswe = him / her

moykyu = you (plural)

moykyuhey = yourselves

5.3.5 - Prepositions

Prepositions come before locations to create prepositional phrases.

I walked through the park. = pan i myesami byo gemo.

“boy” is the catch-all preposition like “je” in Esperanto.

boy pey kotu a pan i mye legi boy pindin. = For 10 hours I worked in this place.

For things like physical locations, it's best to use the most literal word for the situation.

I'm at home. = pan e law pan digyo. [I am in my home.]

If the use of a word as a preposition is unclear, “boy” can be attached to it as a prefix.

They eat using a fork. =

swe i mabo mohu pito. (they eat method fork)

swe i mabo boymohu pito. (they eat for-method fork)

5.3.6 - Conjunctions

Many words can be used as conjunctions to create new clauses.

pan i dani e gaw, bemyu twalay pika = I like animals, but not bugs.

5.4 - Word Order

Sentences are Subject-Verb-Object order by default. Verb phrases are marked with the “i” particle, and object/complement phrases are marked with the “e” particle.

pan i dani e gaw = I like animals.

Subjects can be marked with the “a” particle, but this is only required when the subject isn’t at the beginning of the sentence.

kay a kyu i dani e gaw? = Do you like animals?

- Question particle is at the beginning instead of the subject

e gaw i dani a pan = (It is) animals (that are) liked (by) me.

- Sentence is changed to OVS order

mayhan a swe i bani e domay = Today they’re meeting a friend.

- Context that isn’t meant to be tied solely to the subject/verb/object should come at the beginning of the sentence

5.4.1 - Verb Phrases

Verb phrases can be formed just by using verbs back to back.

swe i subi boti sin e san = They must want to do that.

5.4.2 - Noun Phrases

Noun phrases are generally just nouns with their descriptors preceding them.

moypin boku twadoy labe koko = these four small round rocks

The particle “hoy” puts descriptors after a noun.

bado hoy kiwe = valley of green = green valley

bya hoy kaw bade = man of much strength = very strong man

“teso” can also be used to create more detailed noun phrases, which will be covered in a later section in more detail.

pan i dani e koko teso e doy = I like rocks that are big.

5.4.3 - Questions

Word order stays the same for questions. “kay” can be used as a question particle and is stated at the beginning of the sentence, especially for yes/no questions.

kay a kyu i gwi madu? = question, you are good feeling = Are you feeling well?

When asking about something that isn't a yes/no question, replace the thing you're asking about with “kya.”

kay a san goy i swa e kya? = question, that thing is what = What is that thing?

5.4.4 - Compound Sentences

If you have multiple subjects, verbs, or objects, use the corresponding particle. This will generally be the most unambiguous method, but “sya” (and) can be used too depending on the situation.

a kyu a pan i dani i mabo e kupa e lano = You and I like and eat fruit and bread.

“teso” is a word that translates to English's “that” or “which,” and introduces a new clause into the sentence. By default, it turns the previous word into the subject of the next clause.

pan i dani e goy teso e gwi = I like things that are good.

If there is a new subject introduced afterwards, then “teso” just introduces a new clause.

pan i dani e goy teso a kyu i dani. = I like things that you like.

“key” means “with”. When used in a single phrase, it can imply two things are together:

pan i dani e limya e lano = I like milk and (I also like) bread.

pan i dani e limya key lano = I like milk with bread.

When used between 2 phrases, “sya” can serve as a connector if the two sentences are related. Use “bemyu” to create a contrast.

lano e sude bemyu e gwi = Bread is dry, but good.

lano e sude sya e gwi = Bread is dry, and (so it is) good.

5.5 - Compound Words

Compound words are constructed by having the base word at the end, and the describing words preceding it. Any root word can be used at any part of a compound as long as it makes sense.

IMPORTANT: Generally, Dagapya is not designed to assign a single meaning to every compound word. Compound words are just meant to describe a concept, and if a specific meaning for a specific compound becomes popularized, that is OK as long as the meaning can be surmised from the word itself.

Example:

gusodun = dig-tool = shovel

Compound words differ from using adjectives since they imply an innateness to the concept, while using adjectives just states that something happens to be a certain way.

doy haso = large village

doyhaso = large-village = town

It's highly recommended to be as literal as possible for compound words, since certain concepts might not translate directly to other languages. For example, an English speaker might be tempted to use “fish” by itself as a verb, but the word itself does not imply the whole meaning, which would be better expressed with:

sapabaki = fish-catch = to fish / to capture fish

That being said, Dagapya still allows lexicalization, and in some rare cases, compounds that are not entirely logical. These should be saved for very few and very common words that cannot be expressed in any other way, in order to maintain the language's learnability.

losohan = moon-day = Monday

5.5.1 - Ordering

When deciding on the order of compound words, you can imagine it as each section being a larger and larger compound.

musumodyo = sleep + furniture = bed

musumodyolemo = sleep-furniture + cloth = bed-cloth = blanket

musumodyolemakebo = sleep-furniture-cloth + cover = bedsheet

If you want to reorder it, use the particle “twi” which separates the groups.

sumekutodaw = adult-school + person = college + person = college student

sumetwikutodaw = adult + school-person = adult student

5.6 - Numbers

Numbers can be built onto each other using the base numbers.

1 2 3 4 5 = min day tyo boku paya

6 7 8 9 10 = gesi kewe hopya lani pey

11-15 = peymin peyday peytyu peyboku peypaya

16-20 = peygesi peykewe peyhopya peylani daypey

30 40 50 60 70... = tyopey bokupey payapey gesipey kewepey...

hundred, thousand, million, billion = semu siku hamyu togyu

809 = hopyasemulani

- or hopyasemu sya lani

405026 = bokusemusiku sya payasiku sya daypey sya gesi

- This could also be one word, but we'll skip that for now

For fractions, use the word “kwa,” which by itself means fraction/ratio/proportion.

kwatyo = fraction-three = one third

daykwatyo = two-fraction-three = two thirds

peykewe kwa hopya = 17/8

5.7 - Tenses and Moods

Tenses and moods are formed just by adding the related particles before the verb.

pan i pyu = I go

pan i mye pyu = I (past) go = I went

pan i dyu pyu = I (future) go = I will go

pan i myu pyu = I would go

If used after a verb marker, “yoy” (translates to “yo!” or “hey!”) can be used as an imperative marker to create commands.

i yoy pyu! = Go!

Past/future tense is not required if it's implied by the sentence.

seyhan a pan i pyu. = Tomorrow I (will) go.

5.8 - Important Words

5.8.1 - Inversion Prefix

“twa” is the inversion prefix, which inverts the meaning of a word. This is very important for referring to concepts not directly in the vocabulary

twakoy = (not)-far = close/near

Note that this is NOT the same as negating the meaning of a word, which can be done with “soy”, which means zero.

twadoy = (not)-big = small

soydoy = zero-big = not big (could be small or medium sized)

“twa” only applies to the word it directly precedes.

twapidepide = (not)-problem problem = easy problem

5.8.2 - Comparatives and Superlatives

“baw” and “byu” form comparatives and superlatives.

bawgwi = more-good = better

byugwi = most-good = best

5.8.3 - A E I O U

These are the single-letter vowel particles. “a” marks the subject of the sentence, “e” marks the direct object/complement of the sentence, “i” marks the verb of the sentence, “o-” marks loanwords, and “u” marks the indirect object of the sentence.

For “correct” Dagapya, these are mandatory in certain situations:

- Use “a” when the subject is not the beginning of the sentence
 - Can be due to context/question marker, OR if the sentence order is not Subject-Verb-Object
- Always use “e” when there is a direct object/complement in the sentence
- Always use “i” when there is a verb in the sentence
- Always use “o-” when the word is a loanword
- Always use “u” when there is an indirect object in the sentence

Example:

kay a kyu i dyo e san goy u oMeli = Did you give that thing to Mary?

In written form, o- is always attached to the word as a prefix, while a/e/i/u can optionally be attached, as long as a word only has 1 vowel prefix. This does not change how the sentence is pronounced, and is only for preference. Likewise, the o-prefix can be pronounced as a separate word.

polusaw apan idani e oHanbuga = I always like burgers.

Generally, using the same particle multiple times will apply to the other particles within the same phrase. For example, if multiple objects are given, they will all be objects of the same verb.

pan i dani e pila e sapa e hisa. = I like birds and fish and reptiles.

However, repeating one particle after a different particle does not make the previous words apply to the new one. For example, a new verb introduced after the direct object won't apply to that direct object.

pan i dani e koko i mabo e sapa = I like rocks and eat fish.

- “rocks” does not apply to “eat”

While this rule is potentially obvious to say, it's most important for alternative word orders.

e siko a pan i dani, e sumo i twadani = Salty I like, sweet I dislike.

The subject is an exception where it will generally be assumed to apply to the whole phrase unless either a new subject is introduced, or a new phrase is introduced.

pan i mabo e lano i pyu, a pan suka i lopi = I eat bread and go, my sibling stays.

pan i loy e pila teso i bali = I watch a bird that flies.

5.9 - Omission

Syllables build up really fast in Dagapya. However, Dagapya allows you to drop any word in a sentence **as long as the word is obvious from context**. It's recommended to use this sparingly in texts that require explicit detail, but is expected to be common in casual conversation.

5.9.1 - Adjectives in Compounds

Since words can't be expressed by a single compound, there may be some cases where you want to drop adjectives to make a sentence shorter. For example:

Without adjective-dropping:

i dyo e sinsudelemo u pan. = Give the do-dry-cloth to me. = Give the towel to me.

With adjective-dropping:

i dyo e lemo u pan. = Give the cloth to me.

In a situation where e.g. your roommate has just washed their face and the only loose cloths in the area are towels, there would be no need to specify which type of cloth they're asking for.

5.9.2 - Nouns

Subjects and objects can also be omitted if they are obvious from context. For example, when asking someone a question, you don't need to specify that they are the subject.

With subject-dropping:

kay; i sin e san? = Did (you) do that?

With object-dropping:

kate, a pan i mye sin. = Correct, I did (that).

5.9.3 - Verbs

If the only verb in a phrase is “swa” (to be), it can be dropped so that “e” functions as the copula instead. This works for nouns and adjectives.

pan e daw. = I (obj. marker) person. = I am a person.

pan e sapye! = I (obj. marker) cool = I’m cool!

It cannot be dropped if it’s used in a verb phrase, since that would change its meaning.

pan i dani swa e domay = I like being a friend.

pan i dani e domay = I like friends.

Since subjects can be dropped, you can have a sentence that just starts with “e” to have the meaning along the lines of “there is” or “it is,” without the need of a dummy pronoun like English.

e teno. = There is snow. / It’s snowing.

5.10 - Formality and Politeness

Formality and politeness can be very complicated in some languages, so by default, all speech in Dagapya is considered to be both formal and polite. Speakers are not required (or even encouraged) to reform their speech patterns in order to come off as more polite, outside of cases where the content of speech is explicitly impolite (e.g. directly insulting the listener).

This means that regular speech in Dagapya can be used equally in formal settings (e.g. giving a presentation) and informal settings (e.g. talking casually with friends) with no modifications. It also means that speech does not have to be modified to speak to people that commonly require more politeness in other languages (e.g. teachers and parents) or people that commonly require less politeness (e.g. younger siblings and children).

Politeness cannot be modified by speech patterns alone, and depend entirely on the content of speech. This applies to formality as well: using a construction like “swe i

swa e gaw” instead of “swe e gaw” is not more or less formal than the other. However, since auxiliary languages tend to discourage words that would normally affect formality (like slang), there is the suffix “gway” that creates informality, mainly to allow more expressiveness in speech, but also to allow for more accurate translation.

bamu! = Hello!

bamugway! = Howdy! (approximately)

This suffix can also be inverted with “twa,” but since Dagapya is already formal by default, this suffix makes the word overly formal.

pumi... = Please...

pumitwagway... = I humbly beg of you... (approximately)

It is also worth noting that as an affix that is largely used to insult, “syen” is the closest thing to being an impoliteness affix, but not every sentence using “syen” is necessarily impolite.

san e dey. = That’s a house.

san e deysyen. = That’s a hovel.

5.11 - Loanwords

Since Dagapya has an internal logic to the way words are constructed, loanwords inherently can’t follow this and are considered outside the base vocabulary. These include names, technical terms, and more that can’t be handled by the language’s system.

Loanwards are handled similar to toki pona’s tokiponization concept: names and technical terms can be used in the language, but aren’t considered part of the vocabulary. In Dagapya’s case, loanwords will usually be nouns by default.

Loanwords have a “o-” prefix for the whole phrase, and are preferred to be modified to fit the language’s phonology/phonotactics with the closest sounds. It’s preferred to capitalize the letter immediately after the loanword “o-” prefix to signal it as a name.

Example:

oPasata = pasta

Dagapya’s tonic stress rules do not apply to loanwords, but the “o-” prefix should never be stressed. It is preferred that the speaker stresses the penultimate

(second-to-last) syllable, if the loanword has more than one syllable. Due to the way that they are constructed, loanwords cannot be used in compound words, but they can have adjectives and be used in any part of a sentence.

Also, loanwords can begin with a vowel for recognizability. In speech, an H can be inserted after the O if the speaker considers it difficult to pronounce (e.g. with multiple vowels in a row), but this should not be written.

pan matu e oAsya = My country is Asia.

- Four vowels in a row may be awkward!

~> "pan matu e oHasya"

5.11.1 - Translation Preferences

Loanwords should generally be saved for proper nouns (e.g. place and people's names), but can also be used to refer to specific concepts when specificity is needed. However, it's preferred that speakers of Dagapya try to stick to vocabulary from the language when they can.

The general rule of thumb is that if a word appears in the [Globasa dictionary](#) for 12+ languages AND the majority of the top 5 spoken languages, then it can be considered "nearly universal," i.e. most people around the world will most likely be able to decipher it with enough context. However, any words that are not in all of the top 5 spoken languages should be used with care, with preference towards making a compound word instead of using the loanword. These rules may change later on to be more strict.

When creating a loanword for Dagapya, try to follow these rules of thumb:

- For people's names, call them by the preferred version of their name when known
- For place's names, call it by what the place calls itself, especially if it prefers that name
- For object names, tend towards the most universal version of the name
- Words that can be translated directly to Dagapya can be calqued if it seems appropriate

Of course, if there's already an official loanword in the dictionary, try to use that.

When translating sounds to Dagapya:

- Tend towards adding syllables to include more consonants rather than removing syllables

- Loanwords should follow the general phonotactics but don't need to follow the 2-syllable structure rules
- R sounds should generally be turned to L
- Soft TH sounds (e.g. [ð]) should generally be turned to D
- J sounds (e.g. [ʒ], [dʒ]) should generally be turned to DY
- CH sounds (e.g. [tʃ]) should generally be turned to TY
- SH and sharp TH sounds (e.g. [ʃ], [θ]) should generally be turned to S
- V sounds should generally be turned to B
- F sounds should generally be turned to P
- If there are 2 vowels in a row that can't be resolved with W or Y, insert an H between them to avoid a diphthong
- If there are 2 consonants in a row that cannot be resolved with a glide, insert an extra vowel that's the same as the last one.
 - If it's the first syllable, insert a vowel that's the same as the next
 - If the last letter is an invalid consonant and there's no agreement between languages for an ending vowel, repeat the last vowel

Examples:

Radio -> oLadyo

Tea -> oTyay (from Chai)

Canada -> oKanada

Jiminy Cricket -> oDimini Tigya (cricket)

One Piece -> oWan-Pisu

- Multi-word loanwords are connected with a hyphen.

Informally, it's perfectly fine to take the name directly and just precede it with o- or o.

Minecraft = oMaynklapa = oMinecraft = o Minecraft

5.12 - Word Categories

Dagapya has a number of word categories that describe how specific words function. Note that these words may not have the exact same meaning as their equivalents in English linguistics.

5.12.1 - Root Words

Root words account for the majority of Dagapya's vocabulary. They are primarily content words that can be used as any part of speech, and can compound infinitely with each other in any way a speaker wishes.

haw = life / alive / to live

hawmun = life

hawben = alive

hawbendawhoyhasodigyo = alive person of a village home

Root words are only 1 or 2 syllables, where 2 syllable words must follow a CVC(G)V(G)(N) pattern and 1 syllable words follow a C(G)V(G)(N) pattern where at least 1 glide and/or -N are required.

5.12.2 - Vowel Particles

These are 5 words (a e i o u) consisting of only a vowel. These can be appended to the beginning of a root word, but cannot be appended to the end. They also cannot be appended to each other.

The particle “o” marks loanwords, and only modifies the word it’s attached to. The other particles mark the whole phrase that follows until there is either another particle, or the sentence ends.

i boti dani sahi e pin = to want to like to need this

- boti, dani, and sahi are all marked as verbs

5.12.3 - Prefixes

Prefixes are words that only modify the root word directly following it, rather than the whole compound word. The prefixes are “twa” (inversion marker) and “gwe” (intransitive marker).

twakawtwakumye = (inversion)-very-(inversion)-long = slightly short

- The first “twa” doesn’t affect the second “twa,” making the meaning “slightly short” rather than “slightly long”

The prefixes can also modify any other word category (barring vowel prefixes), including each other.

gwebade = strong

twagwebade = strengthening

5.12.4 - Suffixes

Suffixes are words that, if put at the end of a compound word, modify the whole compound as if it preceded the word. The only suffix is “gway.”

bamu = Hello

bamugway = Howdy (approximately)

Grammatically, suffixes are still allowed to be put into a compound word at the beginning or middle just like a root word, though it may not mean anything in practice.

5.12.5 - Interjections

Interjections are simply exclamations that generally map onto “natural” sounds made without grammatical connection. The 4 interjections are:

- wa (ah! oh! wow! etc.) - Expresses excitement, surprise, shock, or awe
- nn (hmm) - Expresses hesitation or pondering
- yoy (yo! hey! oy! etc.) - Expresses alarm or used to get attention
- gyaw (roar, rawr, etc.) - Noise made by a threatening wild animal or monster

As they are simply noises rather than true “words” (which is also why most begin with invalid letters), they cannot be compounded in any way.

5.12.6 - Other Particles

The other (non-vowel) particles are words that don’t fit neatly into the other categories, and exclusively have one function. There are 2 of these particles: “hoy” which interprets the following adjective phrase as if it preceded the last word, and “twi” which separates adjectives as if they weren’t part of the compound.

kopo hoy kaw lake = book of much red = very red book

kawboteгой = very-blue thing = very blue thing

kawtwiboteгой = very blue-thing = many blue things

5.12.7 -Loanwords

Loanwords are any words that don’t fall under the above categories. They aren’t considered part of the “base vocabulary” (which includes everything above) since memorizing all of them (e.g. names of all countries, scientific terms, every potential human name, etc.) is considered impractical and unnecessary for learners.

Every loanword is marked with the loanword prefix o- and cannot be compounded with any other word. Note that they can still be used as adjectives, however.

oKana da daw = Canada person = Canadian

Loanwords consisting of multiple words are written with a hyphen connecting each one.

One Piece -> oWan-Pisu

Unlike root words, loanwords can technically have an infinite number of syllables, and don't abide by the strict 1 syllable and 2 syllable root word rules, even though they still abide by the phonotactics of the language.

5.13 - Punctuation

Generally, punctuation will be left to writers as they wish, but it would be good practice to write down some intended rules. Note that each section listing "acceptable symbols" are not meant to have any nuance between them, and are all equally acceptable.

5.13.1 - Full Stops

Full stops should generally be represented with the period, representing the completion of a sentence, which represents a full idea or set of related ideas. Acceptable symbols, depending on the user's setting/keyboard:

.	o	[line break]
---	---	--------------

A "full idea" will generally consist of a subject, action, and object, even if only implied. In some cases, this idea can be shortened (if a subject and action don't have an object) or lengthened (if there's an indirect object and/or subclause).

Examples:

e pindin. = (It's) here.

pan i pyu. = I'm going.

kyu i hali e polugoy = You have everything.

To express questions, the question mark (?) can be used instead. For interjections or statements with surprise, excitement, shouting, etc., the exclamation mark (!) can be used instead. Note that these aren't strictly necessary since these moods can be indicated with the words "kay" and "wa/yoy" respectively.

kay a san e kya? = What is that?
e hawben! = It's alive!

5.13.2 - Commas

Commas represent short pauses in speech. Unlike English, these cannot be used to introduce new independent clauses, and its use is completely up to the speaker. The main use cases for commas are creating context, relative clauses, and list members.

pinhan, a pan i maylusi e goy. = Today, I realized something.
pan i dani e hisa, teso e sapye. = I like reptiles, which are cool.
pan i dani e hisa, e sapa, e pila! = I like reptiles, fish, and birds!

5.13.3 - Quotes

When quoting people, texts, or character dialogue, quotation marks are needed.

Valid quotation marks include:

" "	« »	「 」	< >
-----	-----	-----	-----

Unlike English, there are no other punctuation marks needed like commas/half stops before the quotation marks since the quotation marks themselves already mark a separate clause.

He said, "Stop!" = swe i pya "i tepi!"

These symbols can also be used for names of works, though it's fully optional.

I read *War and Peace*. = pan i mye lemi e <Degu sya Homu>.

In spoken speech, you can optionally say "tinu" (quote) to separate a quote from your comment.

"That's wrong," they said. = "san e twakate" tinu a swe i ludi.

If punctuation is not part of the quote itself, it can be kept outside of the quotation marks.

That animal is called a "dog." = san gaw i gwesamu e "hugwa".

5.13.4 - Half Stop

In order to create independent clauses, a half-stop is needed. These are grammatically equal to a full-stop, but are a slightly shorter pause meant to connect two related independent clauses. Acceptable symbols:

;	:	—
---	---	---

These are important to use since strictly speaking, Dagapya's single-letter vowel particles always apply to each other UNLESS there is either a full/half-stop or "teso" is used.

kyu i hali e koko, e sapye! = You have a rock, and coolness!

- The rock hasn't been introduced as a separate subject, so "sapye" will be read as a second thing that the original subject has.

kyu i hali e koko, teso e sapye! = You have a rock, which is cool!

- Works fine! Has slightly different nuance.

kyu i hali e koko, a goy e sapye! = You have a rock, it is cool!

- Will be understood in most contexts, but not preferred since it can introduce ambiguity in some edge cases.

kyu i hali e koko: goy e sapye! = You have a rock; it is cool!

- Closest to the intended nuance, and grammatically correct. Note how a half-stop means that the subject marker isn't required to be re-introduced.

If in doubt, just use a full-stop and it will generally be grammatically correct. Using commas will not always be grammatically correct, even if they will usually be understood regardless.

5.13.5 - Brackets

Brackets, parentheses, etc. can add additional information in between other words, as either part of the sentence or as a separate clause. Due to how it's marked (or said in practice), it should generally be distinguishable as to how it's used. Acceptable symbols:

()	[]	{ }
-----	-----	-----

He (and his dog) arrived. = swe (sya swe hugwa) i mye pindinbuli.
He said he liked mushrooms (I certainly do not). = swe i pya teso a swe i dani e pugaw
(pan i sukeben twasin).

5.13.6 - Slashes

The slash indicates that the two options on either side are interchangeable.

/	\
---	---

That's my friend/coworker. = sandaw e domay/keylegidaw hoy pan.

5.13.7 - Hyphens

Hyphens are only formally used for loanwords that have multiple words, to show that it is part of the same concept.

-	‘
---	---

pan i pya e oToki-Pona. = I speak toki pona.

5.13.8 - Other Punctuation

Other punctuation is allowed in Dagapya, but will not have formally written rules.

Please note that when writing out numbers, it is preferred to separate grouped digits with a space, and decimals with either a full stop or comma.

1 000 000 = one million

2 000.5 = two thousand and one half

5.14 - Word Selection Process

The word selection process is difficult for many reasons that won't be listed here, but this section will document some of the criteria for word additions/deletions/sorting.

5.14.1 - Word Sorting

While a word's "default" definition technically doesn't mean much, they were chosen to try to make as much sense as possible. This is partly guesswork based on the concept itself ("jumping" is an action, so it's more likely a verb, rather than the concept of jumping itself which is a noun), but also based on how derivation would logically follow.

One word that was changed was "dig/hole," where it was a verb by default and ended in -i. However, "a dig" doesn't necessarily mean "a hole" – it can also refer to the action of digging itself. The word was changed to end in -O where the default meaning is "hole," since "to hole" something would generally imply the creation of a hole, i.e. digging.

5.14.2 - Word Addition

On paper, word additions are simple: if an idea cannot be expressed by the current vocabulary, then a word should be added. However, there are a lot of complications that can come up in practice.

For one, language can be surprisingly tricky. An idea might seem easy to convey if the words are translated to English, but to other languages, using those words in that combination don't make sense to them. For example, the word "at" has many meanings in English – it can refer to physically being in a place, or it can refer to the time being a specific number. If I translate the sentence word by word, "I will meet you at 5," would that actually make sense in Dagapya? There may be false assumptions of what ideas are actually able/unable to be properly expressed in Dagapya, and a different version of "at" may actually need to be added.

Definitions can also be merged with other words instead of adding a new one at the risk of ambiguity, but maybe that ambiguity is fine. To an English speaker, merging "to do" and "to make" might feel uncomfortable, because they feel like separate concepts, but they're the same word in Spanish. Similarly, "to know" is split off into 2 words in Spanish: one for knowing something, and another for being familiar with something (e.g. "Do you know this guy?"). To English speakers, it's fine that these are merged into one word, but to a Spanish speaker, it might feel too vague.

Since the language is considered to be stable, adding words is being done a lot more cautiously. Here are some guidelines if the community needs to decide on a new word addition:

- 1) Can the idea be expressed logically with the existing set of words?

- a) Some ambiguity is OK as long as it's obvious in context; saying "toothbrush" in English could technically refer to a brush made of teeth, but context can make it obvious that's not what it means
- 2) Can the idea be expressed in a way that's understandable to most cultures?
 - a) Lexicalization is allowed in Dagapya if necessary – for example, even though "Mars-day" doesn't unambiguously nor logically translate to "Tuesday" in all languages, it was chosen as the compound meaning "Tuesday" due to being the most common method between major languages
 - i) This can be difficult to decide, but in this case was chosen over numbers since the first day of the week is less universal, while also avoiding having to add 7 new root words
- 3) Can the idea be expressed with a reasonable number of syllables?
 - a) Many common words can be expressed with a range of 1-4 syllables, and this is considered perfectly valid — 5 is the borderline for "too long" but is still OK if it's not commonly used
- 4) Is the current level of specificity sufficient for most conversations?
 - a) There are no separate root words for "wasps" and "hornets," but how often is the difference important? If the difference is important in that particular conversation, would it be sufficient to just describe the difference?
- 5) Can the word be loaned?
 - a) See the Loanwords section for the full criteria, but a concept being able to be loaned generally disqualifies it from getting a root word.

If the answer is "no" to 3 or more of these, then it may be worth adding a new word. When adding a new word to Dagapya, keep these in mind:

- 1) Every root word is 2 syllables by default; since there are less options for 1-syllable words, and since they're harder to differentiate, 1-syllable words are only reserved for words that are often compounded (even if it's just because e.g. the inversion is common, like "koy" and "twakoy" meaning "far" and "near")
- 2) The word's phonology should be based on the pool of most common sounds between 5+ mostly-unrelated natural languages, preferably with the most spoken ones included (English, Chinese, Hindi, Spanish, Arabic)
 - a) These sounds should then be rearranged to not look familiar to any of these languages, and preferably not other common languages either
 - b) This may result in this specific word being biased more towards specific languages and not others, but this is OK since Dagapya balances out these biases across the language

- c) Some knowledge of these languages is highly recommended: for example, the definite article in Arabic being “al-” would result in heavy bias between words despite not actually being part of the root word
- 3) The word should not be too similar to any existing word in Dagapya in both sound and meaning
 - a) The most problematic minimal pairs would be those that differ only by a voiced/unvoiced sound (P/B, K/G, T/D) and M/N
 - i) These are only allowed if the words differ largely in meaning — for example, “pyu” and “byu” mean “to go” and “the most” respectively, so it’d be very difficult to mix them up in most conversations with context
 - b) Minimal pairs with similar meaning that differ only in vowels are perfectly OK (e.g. “koka” being “bone” and “koko” being “rock”)
 - c) If the best choice of word is a minimal pair with a similar existing word, it is recommended to add a semivowel so that they differ by at least 2 sounds (e.g. to avoid confusion between “libo”/”lipo”, change “lipo” to “lipyo”)
 - i) Ideally, this semivowel should be based on the natural languages just like the other sounds
- 4) Generally, AVOID using 2 glides and/or an ending -N in a root word
 - a) 2-syllable words have a huge number of combinations to be differentiated, so it should never be necessary to use these
 - b) Ending -N is allowed for 1-syllable words, but is generally discouraged for most root words since it makes compounds more difficult to pronounce due to the consonant clusters
 - i) Try to save these for root words that are usually kept at the end of compounds — see “han” (day) and “dun” (tool)
 - c) Double glides is OK for 1-syllable words if it’s a root word meant to be outside the core vocabulary (see “gway”)
 - i) Technically OK for 2-syllable words if it’s meant to be very uncommon, but generally this should only be reserved for genuine joke words

Of course, these all assume that the new word will follow both Dagapya’s phonotactics and word sorting methods. Do not add a homophone.

5.14.3 - Word Changes

Words in Dagapya were mainly changed either due to resembling a real word too closely, or for being a problematic minimal pair.

Minimal pairs are inevitable as a result of having both a limited phonology and root word length, so Dagapya has no real way to avoid minimal pairs. However, there are a few rules to decide whether a root needs to be modified for being deemed problematic.

- 1) Roots are allowed to differ by a single vowel.

Since there's only 5 vowels, and vowels often indicate different word classes, they should be distinct enough from each other in most cases. For example, "kapo" and "kapi" would be a noun and a verb by default, and the sounds between "o" and "i" should generally be distinguishable.

- 2) Roots are allowed to differ by a single consonant if they're not similar sounds

The sounds "p" and "k" should generally be distinguishable, so two words like "kapo" and "papo" are perfectly valid.

- 3) If roots only differ by a single similar consonant, differentiate them with another letter.

The pairs P/B, K/G, T/D, and M/N may cause confusion in speech. Roots will generally be modified to have either 1) a different consonant to be less confusing, or 2) a glide added to the second syllable so that there are more points to differentiate it with. If the words have considerably different contexts (e.g. a place VS a vegetable), then they may not require changes.

Other word pairs that may cause confusion but aren't considered pressing: T/S, L/D (if the speaker pronounces L as [r]), H/K (if the speaker pronounces H as [x])

5.14.4 - Loanwords

As a language designed for international communication, it would be against its own goals for Dagapya to invent new forms of words that are already widespread, OR for it to create its own version of those words as part of its base vocabulary.

Since again, thorough research is outside of my current resources, I will be using research already done by others.

Globasa lists etymology for each of its words in [its dictionary](#), and by design, it favors whatever's the most universal form of a word. The general rule of thumb that has been used is that as long as the word is 1) present 12 or more of Globasa's source languages, and 2) present in the majority of the top 5 spoken languages (English,

Chinese, Hindi, Spanish, Arabic), it is a language that I would consider as close as can be to “universal.”

These are words that, again, are ideally not able to be expressed unambiguously without a separate word. You can describe “chocolate” as much as you want, but not really in a way while only describing “chocolate.” It needs a separate word for that, and since it sounds basically the same in every language, there should be no issues in using that word in an auxiliary language.

Names (of brands, countries, and people) also MUST be loaned rather than compounded.

5.15 - Alternative Usage

As a minimalistic language, Dagapya allows nonstandard usage of the alphabet, vocabulary, and more, without causing much confusion.

Note that while this nonexhaustive list may be considered acceptable, it is still not standard usage and will most likely come off as “quirky” in some form. It is also recommended to continue standard usage of the language when necessary (e.g. in tutorials and formal translations) to maintain comprehensibility of works across both the past and future.

- Using the letter J instead of Y since it isn’t used in the language, and may be preferred by those who either enjoy an IPA-based alphabet or speak a language that pronounces J as [j]
- Spelling Y and W glides with an I or O/U respectively, when it is a valid pronunciation (e.g. “daw” as “dao” or “dau,” “kay” as “kai,” and “kwa” as “kua” but not “koa,” which would not be pronounced /kwa/ in practice)
- Pronouncing “twa” as: dwa, tya, tay, tan, etc., which are all unallocated for the purpose of keeping “twa” distinguishable
- Applying incorrect tonic stress, which may cause confusion but will still be generally understood
 - If first syllable stress is preferred, an acceptable alternative is to stress every first syllable INCLUDING the vowel particles, treating them as if they are always a prefix, which eliminates ambiguity in the same way as last syllable stress.

6.0 - WRITING SYSTEMS

Dagapya is primarily meant to be written with the Latin alphabet, but alternative writing systems exist.

6.1 - Bukudoli

Bukudoli (space-writing) is an alternate writing system created by Dagapya community members oGodi (Gojidoesit) and oKanoli (holycannoli)! This is the reference sheet below, based on the one created by oGodi. Please note that it is not required to learn Dagapya.

Consonant		Glide		Vowel		Glide	
	P				A		N
	T				E		
	K		Y		I		Y
	B				O		
	D		W		U		W
	G						
	S					bukudoli by oGodi + oKanoli reference by oBekedo	
	L						
	H						
	M		pin		e		buku
	N				doli		

6.2 - Braille

Dagapya can be written in Braille, following the international standard for each letter.

A	B		D	E		G	H	I	
·	:		::	·:		:::	:::	·:	
K	L	M	N	O	P			S	T

:	:	:	:	:	:			:	:
U			Y						W
:			:						:

Note: any other additions to the Braille system (numbers, punctuation, etc.) will be left to the blind community